A-A-51353
12 September 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

KNIFE-CURETTE, EAR
(Sheehy-House)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers knife-curettes of the Sheehy-House design for use during middle ear surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The knife-curettes shall be of the Sheehy-House design suitable for use in surgical procedures of the middle ear. The knife-curettes shall be either the small weapon or large weapon design.

Materials. The knife-curettes shall be fabricated of Class 4 martensitic stainless steel shown in Table 2 of ASTM F899. After proper heat treating, the finished Rockwell hardness shall be C-50 to C-54. The knife-curette shall have a satin or matte finish. As a final finishing operation, the knife-curettes shall be properly passivated. The finished instrument shall comply with the hardness and corrosion resistance requirements of Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Characteristics. The knife-curettes shall have an overall length of 6-5/8 inches. The distal tip shall have an oval-shaped knife positioned 45 degrees from the shaft. The centerline of the handle and shaft shall be in line with the plane of the knife face. The handle shall be 3-5/8 inches long and 7/32 inches in diameter. The handle shall be 6 to 8 longitudinal grooves. The shank shall be 3 inches long, tapering from the handle to the distal end. The instruments shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

Workmanship. The curette knives shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Product Quality Level.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One knife-curette, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as follows. At an inspection level of S-2, corrosion testing shall be performed at a 1.0 percent AQL, hardness testing at 1.5 percent AQL, and dimensional testing at a 2.5 percent AQL.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-8335	Knife-Curette, Ear, Sheehy-House, Small Weapon, 6-1/2 inch (16.5 cm)
6515-01-139-8336	Knife-Curette, Ear, Sheehy-House, Large Weapon, 6-1/2 inch (16.5 cm)

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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION A-A-51353

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA - OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 06633

Project No. 6515-3457

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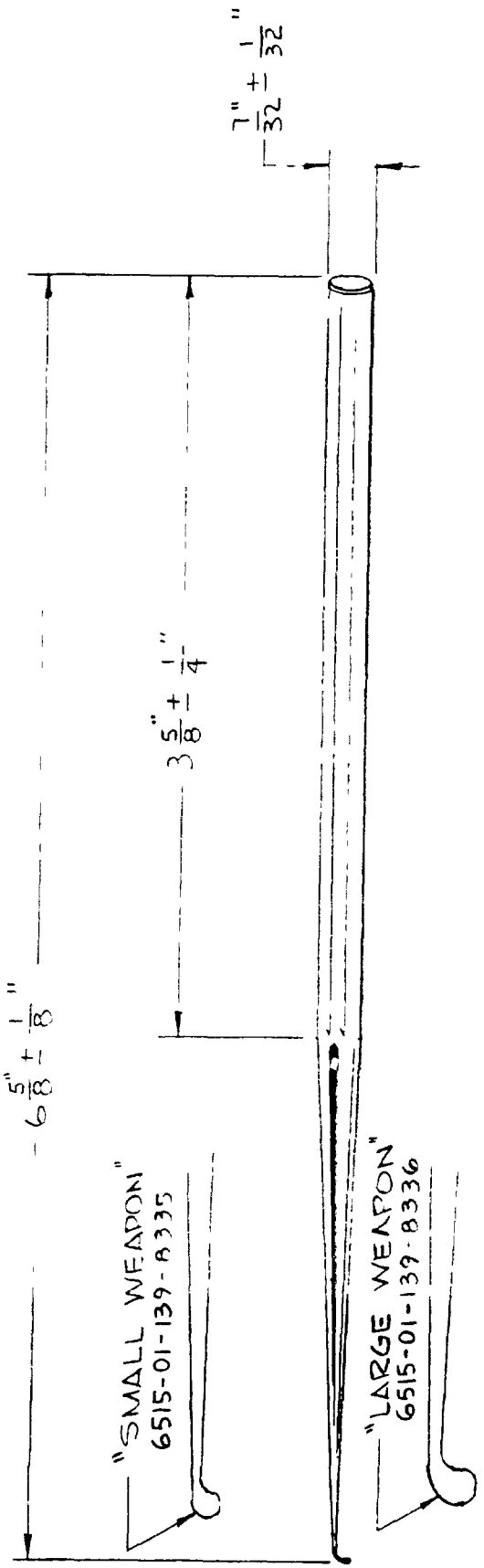


FIGURE 1 KNIFE - CURETTE

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51353	KNIFE-CURETTE, EAR (Sheehy-House)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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